Kabir Vaidya

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Contact Information

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Research Interests

Microeconomic Theory, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Political Economy, Game Theory, Electoral Competition, Systemic Inequality

Education

University of Glasgow

PhD in Economics — Oct. 2023 – present

MRes in Economics — 2021 – 2023

Fergusson College, Pune University, India

BSc in Mathematics — 2018 – 2021

Job Market Paper

Political Clientelism and Elite Capture: Theory and Structural Estimation

This paper extends and develops a political economy model of electoral competition where clientelism and elite capture coexist. I show that institutional frictions in a decentralised system can exacerbate inequality in equilibrium. The model uses endogenous clientelistic pressure from political party, along with voter's 'own' choice of type. As a result, in equilibrium, political preference for the elite is higher than non-elite. As a consequence, the local government's wealth redistribution policy values elite more even though non-elite are in majority. I complement the model with structural estimation using local election data from West Bengal, India. I estimate the model's structural primitives, clientelistic pressure and policy preference. The estimates validates the implications from theory. The inequality that arises from such institutional frictions are inherent in decentralised democratic systems and is structurally conditioned. The framework offers a new way analyse structurally conditioned inequality, shedding light on why imperfect democratic process in unequal societies may perpetuate rather than ease inequality.

Awards & Funding

CoSS Studentship, University of Glasgow (MRes + PhD) — 2021 – 2026

Teaching

University of Glasgow, Teaching Assistant — 2022 – present

ECON 1001 Economics 1A	Fall 2024, 2025, 2026
ECON 1002 Economics 1B	Winter 2025, 2026
ECON 1012 Introductory Mathematics for Economists	Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2026
ECON 1013 Introductory Statistics for Economists	Winter 2023
ECON 2002 Economics 2B	Winter 2025, 2026
ECON 4032 Contemporary Issues in Inequality	Winter 2025, 2026

Conference Attendance

Scottish Economic Society Annual Conference, University of Glasgow	Apr. 2026
2nd South West Economics PhD Conference, University of Exeter	May 2026
Royal Economic Society Annual Conference, Newcastle University	Jul. 2026
Econometric Society European Meeting (EEA-ESEM 2026), Dublin	Aug. 2026
21st annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI Delhi, India	Dec. 2026

Workshops & Training

Understanding prosperity and development in modern world, Royal Society Edinburgh, Edinburgh	Oct. 2026
Structural change, Growth & Economic Development, led by Douglas Gollin, University of Glasgow	Oct. 2026
Diversity and the Political Economy of Social Cohesion, Brunnel University, London	Sept. 2026
Econometrics Workshop, led by Jeffrey Wooldridge, University of Glasgow	Apr. 2026
Causal Inference Methods, Scott Cunningham, University of Glasgow	May 2025
GTA Workshop, Economics Network, University of Strathclyde	Sept. 2022

Academic Service

Student Representative for economics department	2023 - Now
SES Conference, Glasgow	Apr. 2024
RES PhD Conference, Glasgow	Jun. 2023
Royal Economic Society Annual Conference, Glasgow	Apr. 2023

Skills

Programming: Stata, LaTeX, Matlab, R, Julia, Python, QGIS, ArcGIS

Languages: English, Marathi, Hindi, Japanese (basic), Arabic (basic)

References

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